

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

HOUSE
RESOLUTION 1059

By: Munson and Pae

AS INTRODUCED

A Resolution honoring May as Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month; recognizing the cultural and economic impact of Asian/Pacific Americans and immigrants; and honoring Oklahomans of Asian/Pacific descent.

WHEREAS, May is recognized by the United States Congress as Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month, honoring the contributions and paying tribute to generations of Asian Americans and Pacific Islanders (AAPI) who have made our state and nation their home; and

WHEREAS, Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month is celebrated in May to commemorate the immigration of the first Japanese to the United States in May of 1843; and

WHEREAS, May also marks the anniversary of the completion of the transcontinental railroad on May 10, 1869. The majority of those who laid the tracks were Chinese immigrants; and

WHEREAS, the Chinese were the first Asian group to settle in Oklahoma, living in the Guthrie Territory after the Land Run of 1889; and

1 WHEREAS, the Japanese population quickly grew in Oklahoma in the
2 1920s and 1940s, and during World War II, several fought for the
3 United States, including four sons of Kutaro Nishimuta, a farmer in
4 Payne County. His sons served in the U.S. Army 442nd Regimental
5 Unit, an all-Japanese outfit and one of the most decorated units in
6 the war; and

7 WHEREAS, nearly three percent of all Oklahomans identify as
8 Asian American or Pacific Islander, citing origins in Cambodia,
9 China, India, Japan, Korea, Malaysia, Pakistan, the Philippine
10 Islands, Thailand, Vietnam, Hawaii, Guam, Samoa, or other Pacific
11 Islands; and

12 WHEREAS, Oklahoma City is home to "Little Saigon", the Asian
13 District made up of the state's largest population of Asian
14 descendants, predominately Vietnamese. Visitors flock to the
15 district each year to experience the international cuisine, culture,
16 and shopping; and

17 WHEREAS, Asian American and Pacific Islander citizens have made
18 a tremendous impact on our state and nation, serving in vital roles
19 as state and national leaders, starting businesses, making
20 breakthroughs in science and technology, serving in our military,
21 excelling in sports, arts, education, and more.

22 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
23 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

1 THAT the month of May is recognized by the Oklahoma State
2 Legislature as Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month.

3 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the contributions of
4 Asian Americans and Pacific Islanders to the history of Oklahoma and
5 the United States.

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